

Depot Replacement: Interim Service Report

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint. Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles.

1. Purpose

Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

Mitigation is available but unglamorous. Two additional relief runs, shifted twelve minutes earlier, absorb most of the shortfall at a cost well inside the contingency already held for this phase. The remainder is best handled by publishing the revised layover times rather than by adding vehicles.

2. Background

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison.

3. Site constraints

Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

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4. Circulation

The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison.

5. Layover capacity

Members should note that the figures below are drawn from the automatic passenger counters, which under-report boardings at the two rear doors by a margin the vendor states as three per cent. No adjustment has been applied; the raw counts are reported so that later revisions remain traceable to their source.

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6. Ridership (bordered)

Corridor	Q1	Q2	Q3
North radial	412,880	428,110	441,207
Orbital west	208,441	203,900	199,884
Cross-river	331,209	349,772	362,015

7. Contingency drawdown (borderless)

Item	Committed	Drawn	Remaining
Relief running	142,000	96,400	45,600
Signage and information	38,500	38,500	0
Temporary lighting	61,200	12,050	49,150

8. Recommendation

The recommendation is therefore to proceed, with the reporting requirement attached, and to bring a further report in the autumn once a full quarter of post-occupancy data is available for comparison. The depot replacement programme was approved on the understanding that service levels would be maintained throughout construction. That assumption has not survived contact with the schedule: the temporary layover facility is smaller than the site it replaces, and peak-hour vehicle circulation is now the binding constraint.

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